

TEAM UPDATE: ISC2 x CYBLACK Cybersecurity Bootcamp Team Update 3 (June 15, 2025)

Hello Team,

Week 3 of our ISC2 x CYBLACK Cybersecurity Bootcamp was an insightful session as we tackled our first task presentation on access control. Guided by our facilitator: Maryam Shuaibu Aliyu, we audited file permissions, fixed access control gaps, and built a robust policy in compliance with ISO 27001. Here's a recap of Sunday...

Key Events and Session Highlights

Sunday, June 15: Access Control Task Presentation

Event: Our team presented our access control task findings as well as all other groups. We audited the /company directory to ensure users (Alex, Sarah, Jake, Linda) had role-appropriate access.

Key Topics:

- **Identified violation:** Alex, an intern, had unauthorized access to HR_Payroll, which poses a threat to the security infrastructure of the company.
- We fixed it by removing Alex's access, aligning with the Principle of Least Privilege.
- We drafted a two-page ISO 27001-compliant access control policy, mandating strong passwords, multi-factor authentication, quarterly reviews, and more.

This showed how poor access control, like Alex's access to payroll info, could lead to breaches, lawsuits, or lost trust, as seen in real-world cases.

Key Notes:

- RBAC ensures permissions match job roles (HR sees payroll, not engineering).
- MFA and access log monitoring (retained for 12 months) boost security but aren't foolproof against social engineering.
- Policies must be reviewed annually, with disciplinary action for non-compliance.
- Maryam's feedback highlighted how access control preserves the CIA Triad.

Key Cybersecurity Concepts Covered

- **Principle of Least Privilege:** Users like Alex should only access what's essential for their role. Unauthorized access risks unintentional damage.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Assigns permissions based on roles, thereby streamlining security.
- **Access Control Policy:** Requires MFA, strong passwords, immediate access revocation for ex-employees, and quarterly audits. Annual policy reviews ensure compliance, with penalties for violations.
- **Risk Management:** Fixing violations like Alex's access cuts breach risks, saving costs and reputation. Quarterly simulations test controls as well. You know, we humans are the weakest link in cybersecurity.
- **Human Error:** 90% of breaches stem from mistakes, emphasizing training and audits. Without policies, employees could harm systems, intentionally or not.

Action Items and Reminders

Next Session: Task Presentation (**Due Wednesday, June 25**): Incident Response. Please let's review slides/recordings and prepare for it.

Class Starts Saturday June 28, 2025 on Introduction to Network and Network Security with facilitator: Nkeriruka Madu